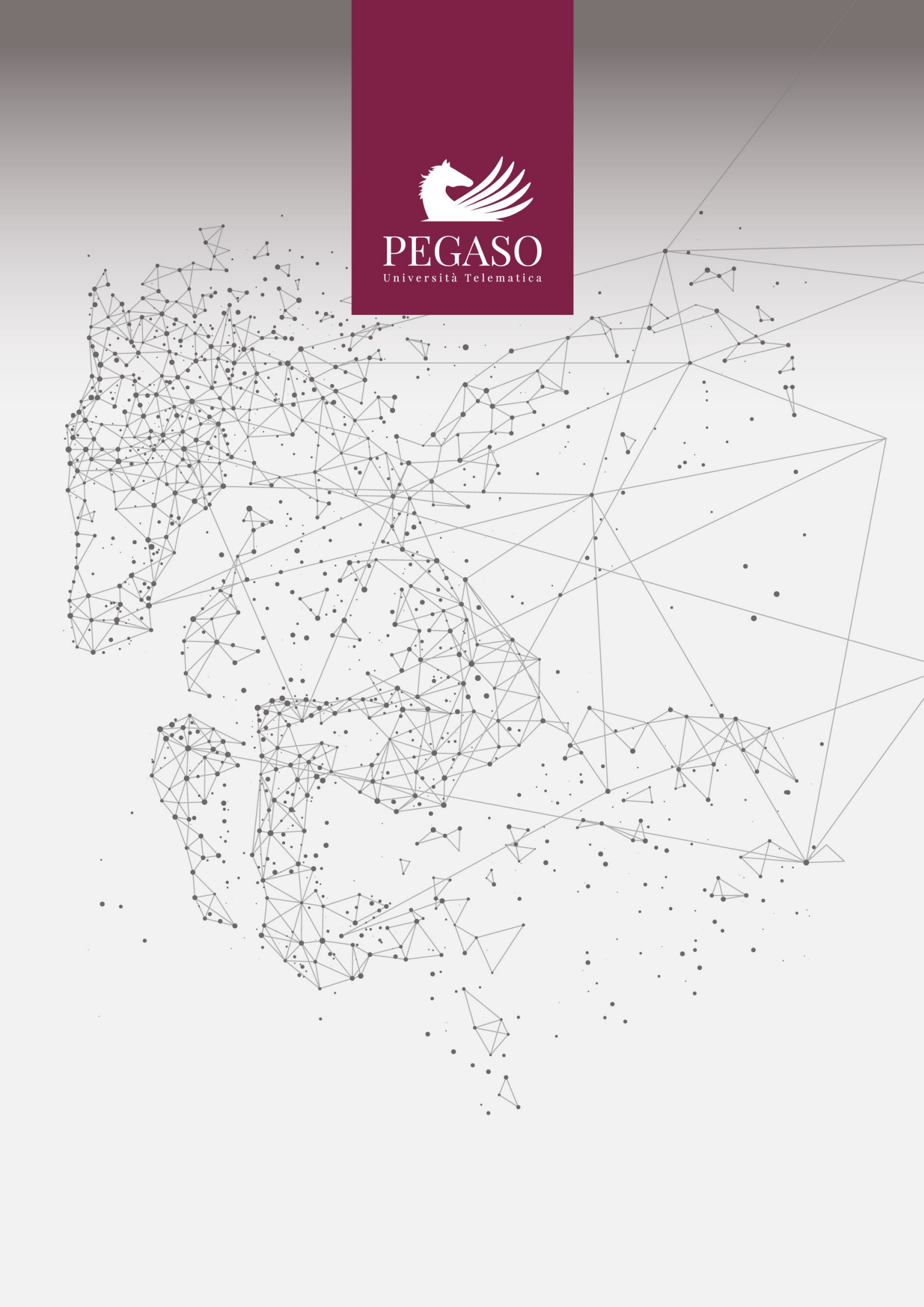

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1. Adverbs

Formation of adverbs from adjectives

1. Many adverbs are formed by adding -ly to the adjective form of the word, e.g. clear → clearly.

For adjectives ending in -y, drop the y and add -ily, e.g. happy → happily.

For adjectives ending in -le, drop the e and add -y, e.g. gentle → gently.

For adjectives ending in -ic, add -ally, e.g. automatic → automatically.

2. Some words ending in -ly are adjectives only, not adverbs, e.g. cowardly, friendly, silly. If an adverb is needed, a phrase must be used:

They greeted us in a friendly way/manner.

3. Some words ending in -ly can be used both as adjectives and adverbs, e.g. hourly, daily, nightly.

- Take the medicine twice daily (adv). There is a daily (adj) flight to the island.

4. Some adverbs have the same form as adjectives, e.g. early, fast, hard, still, straight, better, best, worse, worst.

- He's got a fast (adj) car and he drives it fast (adv).
- She has straight (adj) hair. He looked straight (adv) at me.

5. Some adverbs have two forms, one like the adjective and the other form ending in -ly, e.g. clear, close, direct, easy, free, hard, high, late.

There is usually a difference in meaning.

- Stand clear of the doors. (= keep away)
- Try to speak more clearly. (= so we can understand)
- He works very hard. (= he makes a lot of effort)
- He had hardly any petrol left. (= almost none)

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- The balloon was high up in the sky. (= a long way up)
- They think very highly of you. (= have a good opinion)
- Children under twelve travel free. (= don't have to pay)
- You can walk freely in the hotel grounds. (= without restrictions)
- The train arrived late. (= after the time it was expected)
- He's not been very well lately. (= recently)[1]

Comparison of adverbs

The comparison of adverbs is similar to that of adjectives.

more/less/the most + adverb

To make comparative forms of adverbs, we use more + adverb (+ than).

This ice cream melts more quickly than the one with a higher fat content.

You can live more cheaply in cities.

The opposite of **more + adverb** is **less + adverb**.

You clean the flat less often than me.

The superlative is **the most + adverb**.

We all speak quickly but she speaks the most quickly of us all.

Some comparative adverb forms are irregular. They have the same form as the comparative adjective.

For example, well + better, badly → worse, far → further, fast → faster, high - higher, early › earlier, late → later, soon - sooner

Adverbs of manner

These adverbs are used to say how the action of the verb is carried out.

1. Common adverbs of manner include *accurately, badly, carefully, patiently, straight and well*. They usually come in the middle of the sentence, after the main verb. If the verb has an object, the adverb comes after the object.

- He spoke (the words) clearly.
- She went straight to the house.

[1] J. Bell and A. Thomas, *Gold First Coursebook New Edition*, Essex, Pearson Education Limited, 2014 (161)

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2. Prepositional phrases may also be used adverbially to answer the question *How*?

- I ordered the book over the internet.

- He shouted in a loud voice.

Adverbs of frequency

1.These adverbs are used to talk about how often we do things. We can put them in order from most often to least often like this:

always

almost always

generally/normally/regularly/usually

frequently/often/sometimes occasionally

almost /never/hardly ever/rarely/seldom

not... ever/never

2. In statements and questions, these adverbs come

* after Be when it is the only verb in the sentence.

- I am always a bit depressed in winter.

* after the first auxiliary verb when there is more than one verb.

- I have often seen her walking here

* before the main verb when there is only one verb.

- We sometimes watch a video on Friday evenings.

* in questions, after the subject.

- Don't you usually work with Jenny?

3. In negative sentences, *not* comes before *always, generally, normally, often, regularly* and *usually*

- We don't often see him nowadays.

4. With imperatives, **always** and **never** come at the beginning of the sentence.

- Always look on the bright side of life.

- Never refuse an opportunity.

Other types of adverbs used to describe frequency

1. Here are some common adverbs of frequency:

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once / twice. five times / several times + a week, day, month, year

every day, week, month, morning, afternoon, evening

every month, couple of years, few years

on Monday, Tuesday, etc.

on weekdays

at weekends

These adverbs usually come at the end of a sentence.

I phone my mother several times a day,

He goes running every morning.

They go to the gym twice a week.

Several times a month, we go to the theater.

Adverbs of Attitude

These adverbs do not modify the verb, but express the speaker's opinion or attitude.

1. The following adverbs explain how he/she is feeling:

honestly, personally, seriously, etc.

- Personally, I think it's wrong to hunt animals.

- Seriously, this is an important question.

2. The following adverbs comment on how likely something is:

actually, certainly, clearly, definitely, maybe, obviously, perhaps, possibly, probably, surely, etc.

- Perhaps/Maybe it will rain tomorrow.

- Surely he is going to come?

- We'll probably be late.

3. The following adverbs explain the speaker's reaction to some event: annoyingly, hopefully, luckily, naturally, surprisingly, understandably, etc.

- Hopefully, we'll win the match.

- Annoyingly, I forgot my phone.

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4. Adverbs of attitude usually come at the beginning of the sentence. However, the adverbs certainly, definitely, possibly and probably usually come in the middle of the sentence, after the verb be, before the main verb, or after the first auxiliary verb.

- He is definitely not a friend of mine.
- I'll certainly be seeing her tomorrow.

Modifiers and intensifiers

USE: We can use adverbs to make adjectives, other adverbs and verbs stronger (intensifiers) or weaker (modifiers).

1. We can use these adverbs before gradable adjectives (i.e. adjectives that can be used in the comparative) and adverbs:

- very, extremely, really, particularly, terribly (emphatic)
- quiet, pretty, fairly, rather (weaker than very)
- a bit

-I felt terribly upset when I heard the news.

-He drives rather fast.

-I thought the story was a bit silly.

Take note: *quite* has two meanings.

The picture was quite good. (= good but not very good)

Her cooking was quite wonderful. (= very, very good)

2. Adverbs such as *almost. barely, hardly, nearly and scarcely* have a negative meaning. They come in the middle of the sentence.

- I almost/nearly missed the train.
- We could barely hear the speaker
- She hardly knew anyone at the party.

3. Extreme or absolute (non-gradable) adjectives include: amazing, boiling, disastrous, fantastic, freezing, impossible, marvelous, superb, wonderful, ete. We can use the following adverbs with extreme adjectives: *absolutely, really, completely.*

- The special effects were absolutely amazing.

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- I've just read a superb new book about Egypt.

- I love swimming in the sea, but it's absolutely freezing at this time of year.

4. We can use these adverbs to emphasize both adjectives and verbs: *just, completely, totally* (= in every way).

- I completely/ totally forgot about your birthday.

- It's completely impossible to finish in time.

- You look just fantastic.

- Let's just go.[2]

[2] J. Bell and A. Thomas, *Gold First Coursebook New Edition*, Essex, Pearson Education Limited, 2014 (162-163)

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2. Confusing Adverbs and Adverbial Phrases

EXERCISE

Confusing Adverbs and Adverbial Phrases

Match each pair of adverbs with a pair of sentences. Then decide which adverb goes where and write it in.

at the moment / actually

especially / specially

ever / even

hard / hardly

in the end / at the end

late / lately

near / nearly

still / yet

1. He trains very ……..at least three hours a day.

It's incredibly foggy. I can …….see anything.

2. I hate it when people arrive …….for meetings.

I haven't heard from Mike ……He must be very busy.

3. …….of a film, I always stay and watch the credits roll.

I didn't want to go, but ……..they persuaded me.

4. I love most kinds of music, but ……jazz.

My wedding dress was …….made for me by a dressmaker.

5. She looks younger than me, but she's …….two years older. ……. they're renting a flat, but they're hoping to buy one soon.

6. I've …….finished my book. I'm on the last chapter.

Excuse me, is there a bank ……here?

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7. Have you found a job …….?

He's 35, but he ……. lives with his parents.

8. Have you ……been to the USA?

I've been all over the USA - I've …….been to Alaska![3]

[3] P. Dummett, J. Hughes, H. Stephenson, *Life Upper Intermediate*, Hampshire, National Geographic Learning, 2013 (155)

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3. Comment Adverbs

Exercise

Read the sentences. Then match the adverbs in italics with the definitions (9-16) below.

I thought the job was going to be difficult, but *in fact* it's quite easy. /in 'fakt/

It took us over five hours to get there, but *eventually* we were able to relax. /I'ventfuali/

Ideally, we'd go to Australia if we could afford it. /ar'di:oli/ *Basically*, it's quite a simple idea. /'beisikli/

I thought they'd broken up, but *apparently*, they're back together again. /a'pærontli/

I'm *certainly* never going back to that restaurant. It was awful! /'sa:tnli/

She's only 14, so *obviously* she can't stay at home on her own. /obviosli/

She's been ill for weeks, but *gradually* she's beginning to feel better. /'gradguali/

9……. in a perfect world

10……. truth is; actually (used to emphasize something, especially the opposite of what was previously said)

11……. in the main and most important way

12…….clearly (used to give information you expect other people to know or agree with)

13……. little by little

14……. according to what you have heard or read

15…….without doubt

16……. in the end; after a series of events or difficulties

Exercise answer key

1. hard/ hardly

2. late/lately

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3. at the end/in the end
4. especially/specially
5. actually/at the moment
6. nearly/near
7. yet/still
8. ever/even
9. ideally
10. in fact
11. basically
12. obviously
13. gradually
14. actually
15. certainly
16. eventually

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